

Xiaomi 14 Civi

Pretty 'Leica'able

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024 has been a remarkable year for the Indian smartphone market.

Various smartphone OEMs have introduced a new series of phones to their portfolio, that were previously unavailable in India. Notable launches include the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro, Xiaomi 14 Ultra, and the Realme GT 6T and GT 6; all of these had predecessors that didn't show up in India. Joining the fray is the Xiaomi 14 Civi, marking the debut of the Xiaomi Civi (Cinematic Vision) series in India. Xiaomi has priced the phone competitively as they know Indian customers resonate with value-for-money devices. Priced starting at just ₹43K, the Xiaomi 14 Civi is equipped with a powerful Snapdragon 8 series processor, a Leica camera array, and a specced-out LTPO display. It competes with other high-end smartphones such as the OnePlus 12R, Nothing Phone (2), and Vivo V30 Pro. Will the Xiaomi 14 Civi establish its presence in the competitive Indian smartphone market? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The design of the Xiaomi 14 Civi is immediately striking. The Xiaomi 14 Civi is available in three distinct-looking colours. The most attractive of all, the Matcha Green colour variant, has a mix of vegan leather and glass-like textures, while the Cruise Blue and Shadow Black colour variants have a matte glass back finish. The pattern on the glass portion of the rear panel is unique on each phone.

The model I reviewed was the Shadow Black variant, which, while classy, simply doesn't have the immediate appeal of the Matcha Green variant.

₹42,999



Build & Design.....75
Features & Specs... 81
Performance &
Camera.....78
Value for Money....79

Weighing in at just 177 grams, the Xiaomi 14 Civi is incredibly light, especially when compared to heftier flagship phones that go past the 200-gram mark. At 7.4 mm, it is also one of the slimmest phones in this segment. Its slim profile and curved edges enhance comfort, while the compact,

well-integrated camera module maintains a sleek appearance.

The vegan leather back and brushed side frame add to its premium feel. The build quality, complemented by Gorilla Glass Victus 2 for protection, ensures durability despite its slim design. The frosted matte glass back is also resistant to fingerprints, unlike the likes of the OnePlus 12R which picks up a lot of fingerprints and smudge marks.

The phone's slim body incorporates an IR blaster but there's no 3.5 mm audio jack. There's an optical in-display fingerprint sensor that's super speedy and accurate. However, the vibration motor is quite weak; the Nothing Phone (2)'s vibration motor is much better.

DISPLAY

The 6.55-inch four-sided micro-curved screen of the Xiaomi 14 Civi is a visual treat. The LTPO AMOLED display supports Dolby Vision and HDR10+ with a P3 colour gamut, delivering vibrant and sharp visuals. The 1.5K resolution and 120Hz refresh rate provide a smooth and immersive experience, whether you're watching videos, playing games, or scrolling through social media.

Unlike the OnePlus 12R which only switches between 60/90/120 Hz, the Xiaomi 14 Civi's display can go all the way down to 1 Hz when static, which enhances battery life.

The slight curvature around the edges minimises distortion and adds to the premium feel. With narrow bezels, the display offers an expansive and enjoyable viewing experience. The display is bright enough on sunny days as well, I got a reading of over 1,300 nits under direct sunlight and the phone peaks at 3,000 nits of brightness when playing HDR content.

PERFORMANCE AND UI

Powered by the Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 processor, the Xiaomi 14 Civi is equipped with LPDDR5X RAM and UFS 4.0 storage. This setup places the phone in the flagship category, with the 8s Gen 3 chipset delivering performance comparable to the Snapdragon 8 Gen 2, though its limited 4MB of L3 cache might impact demanding tasks.

In synthetic benchmarks, the Xiaomi 14 Civi consistently outperformed the OnePlus 12R, which uses the higher-clocked Snapdragon 8 Gen 2, and the Nothing Phone (2) with its Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 chipset. It also beat out the Vivo V30 Pro with the Dimensity 8200 SoC. The Xiaomi 14 Civi scored an impressive 1,412,453 points in AnTuTu and achieved exceptional Geekbench scores of 1977 in Single-Core and 5109 in Multi-Core benchmarks. Additionally, it scored 14,582 points in PCMark Work, showcasing its proficiency in productivity tasks.

While the phone did not undergo our usual suite of GPU benchmarks, it performed smoothly in daily use, handling